

Zac Braddy

Contract Software Engineer

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AI-augmented software engineer with 13 years development experience and 8 years of exclusive startup focus. I took Flocast from concept to paying customers in 5 months and improved Subly's video analysis performance by 4x. Whether you need your first technical person to build your product from scratch or an experienced hand to transform a rushed MVP into a system that will scale with your ambitions, I deliver production-ready results fast.

I work across the modern startup stack (TypeScript, Python, React, AWS, FastAPI, NestJS and more) and have consistently proven I can master new technologies under production pressure. While many developers are still resistant to AI-assisted development, I've gone all in: investing significant effort into mastering agentic coding workflows and AI integrations, and building my own custom development toolkits that give me capabilities you won't find with other contractors.

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer (Contract) 07/2026 – 09/2026

Softwire Ltd Remote, UK

- Brought onto to help the team hit a hard, business-critical delivery that the whole engagement was pivoting on.
- Took sole ownership of the case investigation and management capability and delivered it end-to-end across the full stack including SQL Server schema, migrations and seeds via Prisma, Azure Functions API, shared TypeScript contracts, and the React/MUI portal UI.
- Elevated feature flagging from an ad-hoc convention into a first-class part of the codebase. This involved building a manifest-driven toolkit spanning backend, frontend and the shared contracts package, so new routes and screens are gated by construction rather than convention. This kept trunk-based continuous integration safe right up to the gate.
- Raised the frontend testing bar on every page I touched, pairing unit tests with accessibility and Playwright visual-regression coverage, giving the team a repeatable pattern to apply across the rest of the portal.
- The delivery was made on time, and the capability I had built in parallel meant the team entered the following milestone materially ahead of where it expected to be.

Key Technologies: Fullstack TypeScript, Azure Functions API, Prisma over SQL Server, React, MUI, Tanstack React Query, Azure Databricks, OpenTofu, Azure DevOps CI/CD

Senior Software Engineer (Contract) 03/2026 – 06/2026

Prolific Academics Ltd Remote, UK

- Designed and delivered a production observability MVP to facilitate the launch of Prolific's newly modernised Enterprise Payments System, which would launch during my contract term.
- The MVP covered dashboards for proactive observability: elegantly displaying the "Golden metrics" for all payments related flows through the code. It also considered reactive observability through alerts that would fire when anomalies appeared in these metrics.
- Observability instrumentation was delivered allowing the legacy Django Monolith as we'll as the modernised FastAPI based system to easily report on it's performance, errors and throughput through a well defined and easy to use interface.
- Delivered a repository of production ready terraform files which could be deployed via Github Actions to ensure that the Datadog dashboards and alerts are well defined and configured as well as able to be iterated on without the need for "snowflake" changes being made in the Datadog UI.

Key Technologies: Python, FastAPI, Django, Datadog, Bicep, Azure, Github Actions, Terraform

Senior Software Engineer 09/2025 – 02/2026

Subly Remote, UK

- Transformed the WCAG video accessibility analyser from a "best guess" reporting tool into a system that provides accurate violation detection along with descriptions and actionable remediation guidance for each finding.
- Delivered a 4x performance improvement to the video analysis pipeline, reducing processing time from 26x video length to 6x video length.
- Re-engineered the system's GPT-4o and Gemini integrations through improved prompt engineering, context management, and tool-use patterns, thus increasing the accuracy and consistency of AI-generated accessibility assessments.
- Rapidly up-skilled in FFmpeg, OpenCV, and PaddleOCR to optimise video and image analysis pipelines, identifying performance and accuracy improvements rooted in the specialised algorithms these technologies implement.

Key Technologies: Node/Typescript with Express API, AWS, React, AI integration through Vercel SDK to GPT-4o and Gemini models.

Technical Co-Founder 11/2024 – 06/2025

Flocast Remote, UK

- Built a complete fintech product from concept to paying customers in 5 months as sole technical resource. The tech stack included a NestJS backend, Refine frontend, hosted on Render and AWS with full CI/CD via GitHub Actions.
- Architected integrations with Xero, QuickBooks, and Stripe, enabling the core financial data flows the product was built around.
- Acted as de facto CTO for a non-technical co-founder: translating business ambitions into technical strategy, managing scope, and making pragmatic architecture decisions that prioritised speed to market.
- Adopted an unfamiliar tech stack (TypeScript, NestJS, Refine, Render) from scratch, a deliberate choice to pick the best tools for the job rather than defaulting to familiar ones. This saw me deliver a working proof of concept within the first month that became the foundation of the production MVP.

Key Technologies: Node/Typescript with NestJS backend, Render, React with RefineJS framework, integrations with Quickbooks and Xero

Chief Technology Officer
05/2021 – 04/2024

Odondo
Remote, UK

- As the sole technical resource for the entire 3-year engagement, I transformed a legacy Django monolith into a modern FastAPI-based system built on DDD principles and an Onion architecture.
- Built three React SPAs for distinct user types (clients, agents, admins), underpinned by a shared component library that ensured UI/UX consistency, which accelerated delivery across all three applications.
- Implemented a reliable, scalable, and observable backend using AWS CloudWatch, Lambda, and SQS, with CI/CD via GitHub Actions and Terraform.
- Identified new business opportunities by understanding what Odondo's C-Suite valued most about their product and what attracted their clients and investors. Led the subsequent architectural decisions to adopt AmazonConnect and AWS Workspaces, directly enabling new revenue streams for thesales team and measurably improving customer satisfaction.

Key Technologies: Python with FastAPI backend migrated from legacy Django backend, AWS, React, integrations with AWS Connect and AWS Workspaces

Senior Frontend Developer
03/2021 – 04/2021

LMS
Remote, UK

- Rescued a front-end project under tight deadlines while mentoring the in-house junior developer who owned the project.
- Left the LMS team with a frontend solution that was ready to support their business goals and an in-house team ready and confident to deliver.

Key Technologies: React, Azure

Lead Software Engineer
06/2018 – 01/2021

Koodoo
Nottingham, UK

- Led engineering culture for a growing team, championing continuous improvement practices while mentoring junior developers through hands-on technical leadership.
- Architected a microservices system using Node.js and React to power the business' B2B2C white-labelled mortgage market application. Built React SPAs in a micro-frontends architecture, delivering integrated white-labelled frontend solutions across multiple customer-facing applications.
- Built a system that looked "sharp as a three-piece suit" in the board room during sales pitches, directly supporting business development.

Key Technologies: Node microservices supported through MolecularJS hosted in Kubernetes cluster on GCP. React/Svelte microfrontends for white labelled frontends

Various Software Engineering and Technical Roles
01/2007 – 03/2017

Many Employers
UK and Australia

I've led a rich professional working life supporting businesses in their success via varied technical roles. Though I started working in development in 2013, before that I held various technical roles including technical support and management of support teams as well as enterprise system management for Bendigo Bank, one of the top 5 banks in Australia. I'm happy to share details of this upon request.

Key Achievements

An AI-powered developer providing AI-powered solutions

I build custom LLM-powered development toolkits and leverage AI coding agents (Claude Code, Cursor, Qwen Coder) to deliver at a pace that traditionally requires a larger team. This isn't just about writing code faster; I apply the same AI-augmented approach to the systems I build, delivering production integrations across GPT-4, Gemini, and other models, selected pragmatically based on price, suitability, and client preference. The result is AI-powered features that provide measurable accuracy and performance improvements.

0-to-paying customers specialist

As Technical Co-Founder at Flocast, I was the sole technical resource responsible for delivering a complete fintech platform from idea to its first paying customers in 5 months. Beyond building the product, I ensured my non-technical co-founder understood the technical decisions shaping our business, acknowledging that the best technical strategy in the world fails if informed business decisions can't be made around it.

System modernisation expert

From Django monoliths to hastily prepared proof-of-concepts, I've transformed systems held together with sticky tape and dreams into scalable, well-architected platforms ready to support the next phase of business growth. I bring both the plan and the implementation, and I've done it as the sole technical resource more than once. So believe me when I say, I understand the full weight of those decisions.

Founding team experience

As one of the first four developers at Koodoo, I helped establish technical culture from day one in a team where synergistic focus was essential to success. But I'm equally proven working independently: I was the sole technical resource at both Flocast and Odondo, meaning that from a technical point of view "if it was to be it was up to me."

Core Technical Competencies

Full-Stack 0-to-1 Product Development

Python (FastAPI, Django), Node.js using Typescript or Javascript (NestJS and more!), React, Svelte, modern JavaScript frameworks, Rapid Technology Adoption

Cloud and Infrastructure

AWS (CloudWatch, Lambdas, SQS), Azure, GCP, Render, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

DevOps & CI/CD

GitHub Actions, CircleCI, automated testing pipelines, infrastructure as code

Post Product Market Fit System Modernisation

Anti-corruption patterns, gradual migration strategies, modernisation project strategies that ensure business continuity.

Tools & Frameworks

Various frontend frameworks (React, Angular, Svelte), build tools (Webpack, Vite, Rollup), styling (Tailwind CSS, SASS, Chakra, ParkUI)

Architecture Patterns

Microservices, Event-driven systems, CQRS, DDD, Onion based architecture and monolithic to microservices migration

Modern AI/ML development and integration

Custom-built AI development toolkits that go beyond off-the-shelf solutions, production GPT-4 and Gemini integrations, prompt and context engineering, tool-supported LLM calls, modern agentic coding workflows (Claude Code, Cursor, Qwen Coder, etc.)

Databases

PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS DocumentDB, MS SQL Server, TypeORM, Alembic

Testing & Quality

Vitest, Jest, Pytest, NUnit, TDD practices, pragmatic testing strategies